T.A.L.O.N.

Client User Guide

Installation, setup, enrollment, Reticulum configuration, and field desktop operation.

> Updated May 2, 2026 from the current PySide6 desktop code path.
>
> Screenshots use isolated sample data and do not show live operational records.

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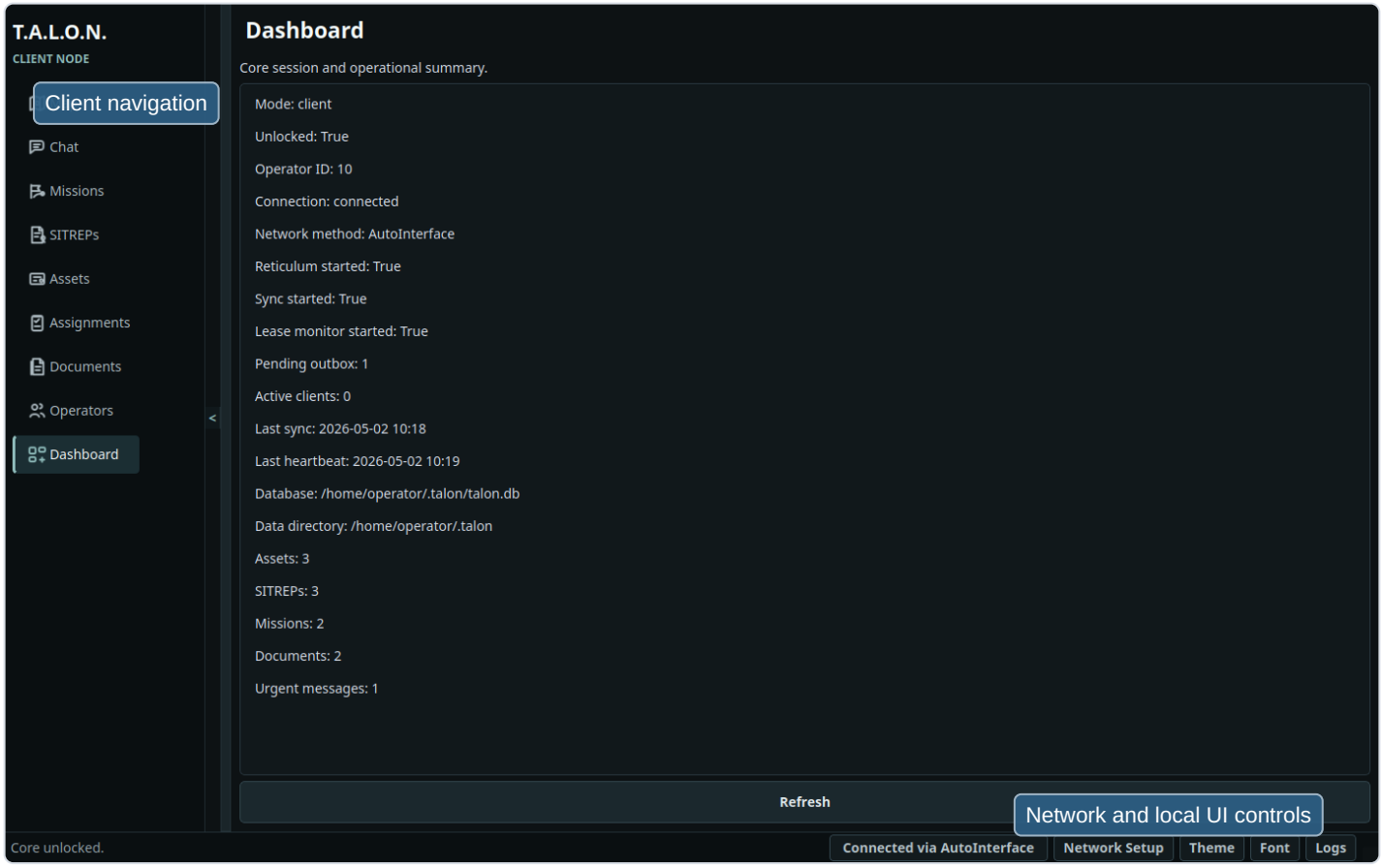
Overview

The TALON client desktop is the field operator interface. It unlocks a local encrypted database, enrolls to a server with a one-time token, syncs over Reticulum, and provides operational workflows without server-only administration pages.

Client operators can work with maps, SITREPs, assets, mission requests, assigned work, chat, synced documents, and their own operator profile. Server authority remains responsible for enrollment, lease renewal, revocation, audit review, key status, destructive deletes, mission approval, and document upload.



Client desktop after enrollment and unlock.

Installation

Install The Client Artifact

Use the client-specific Linux artifact. The installer reads the role marker from the extracted bundle and creates a client launcher.

```
tar -xzf talon-desktop-client-linux.tar.gz
cd talon-desktop-client-linux
bash ./install.sh --yes
```

Installed Paths

Item	Default path or name
Launcher	`~/.local/bin/talon-desktop-client`
Desktop entry	`talon-desktop-client.desktop`, displayed as **T.A.L.O.N. Client**
Data directory	`~/.talon`
Application config	`~/.talon/talon.ini`
TALON Reticulum config	`~/.talon/reticulum/config`
Document cache	`~/.talon/documents`
Launcher log	`${XDG_STATE_HOME:-~/.local/state}/talon/desktop-client-launcher.log`

Useful Installer Options

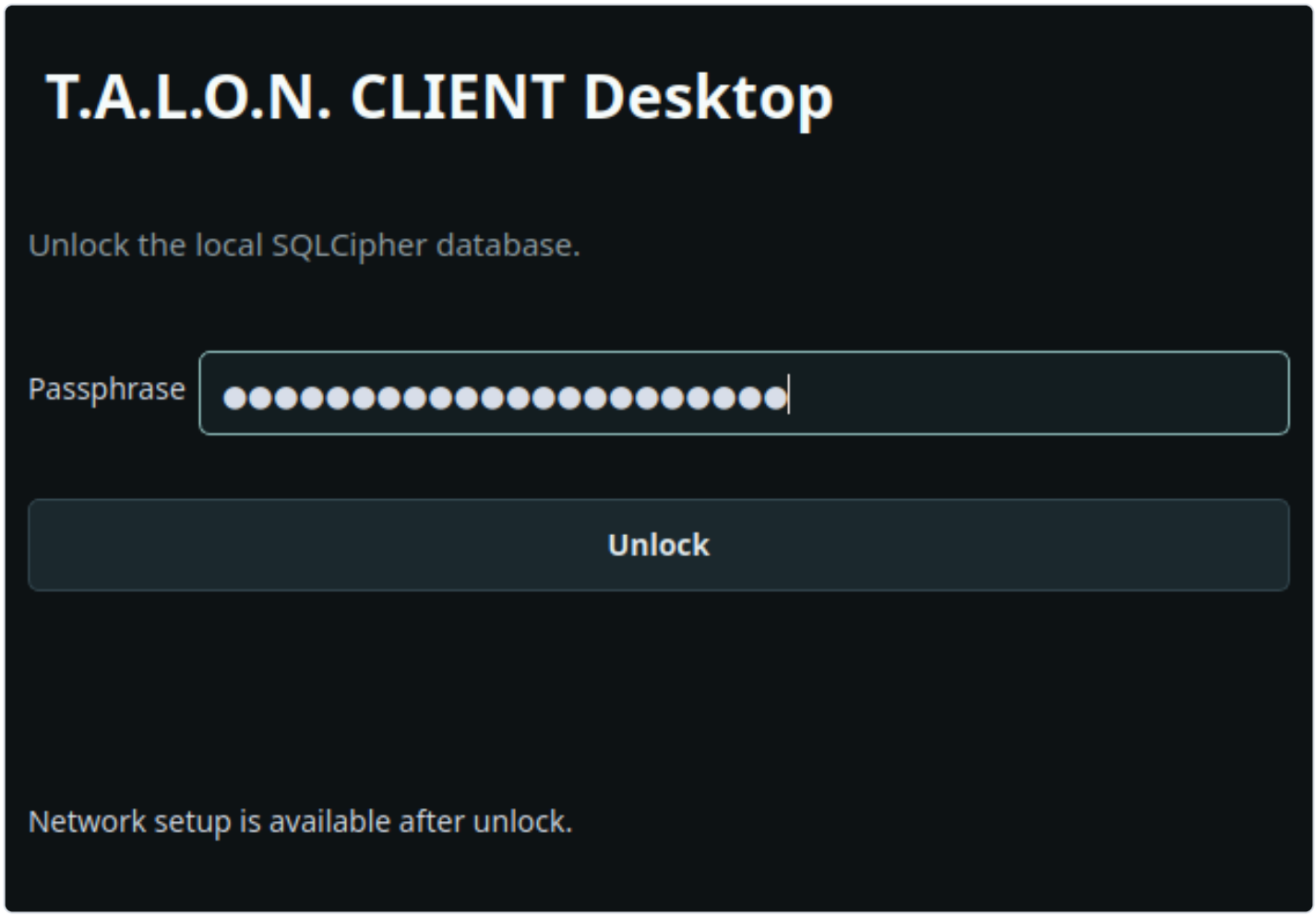
Option	Use
`--yes`	Assume yes for supported system package managers.
`--no-deps`	Skip system runtime dependency installation.
`--no-bin`	Skip role-specific launcher wrapper creation.
`--no-desktop`	Skip desktop entry creation.
`--smoke-test`	Run the installed package smoke test.
`--uninstall --confirm-delete "DELETE TALON DATA"`	Remove local TALON desktop files, data, identities, documents, logs, and launchers.

Role switch warning: a local user profile should not host both roles. Opposite-role cleanup and full uninstall require the exact phrase `DELETE TALON DATA`.

First Run, Reticulum, And Enrollment

Unlock Or Create The Local Database

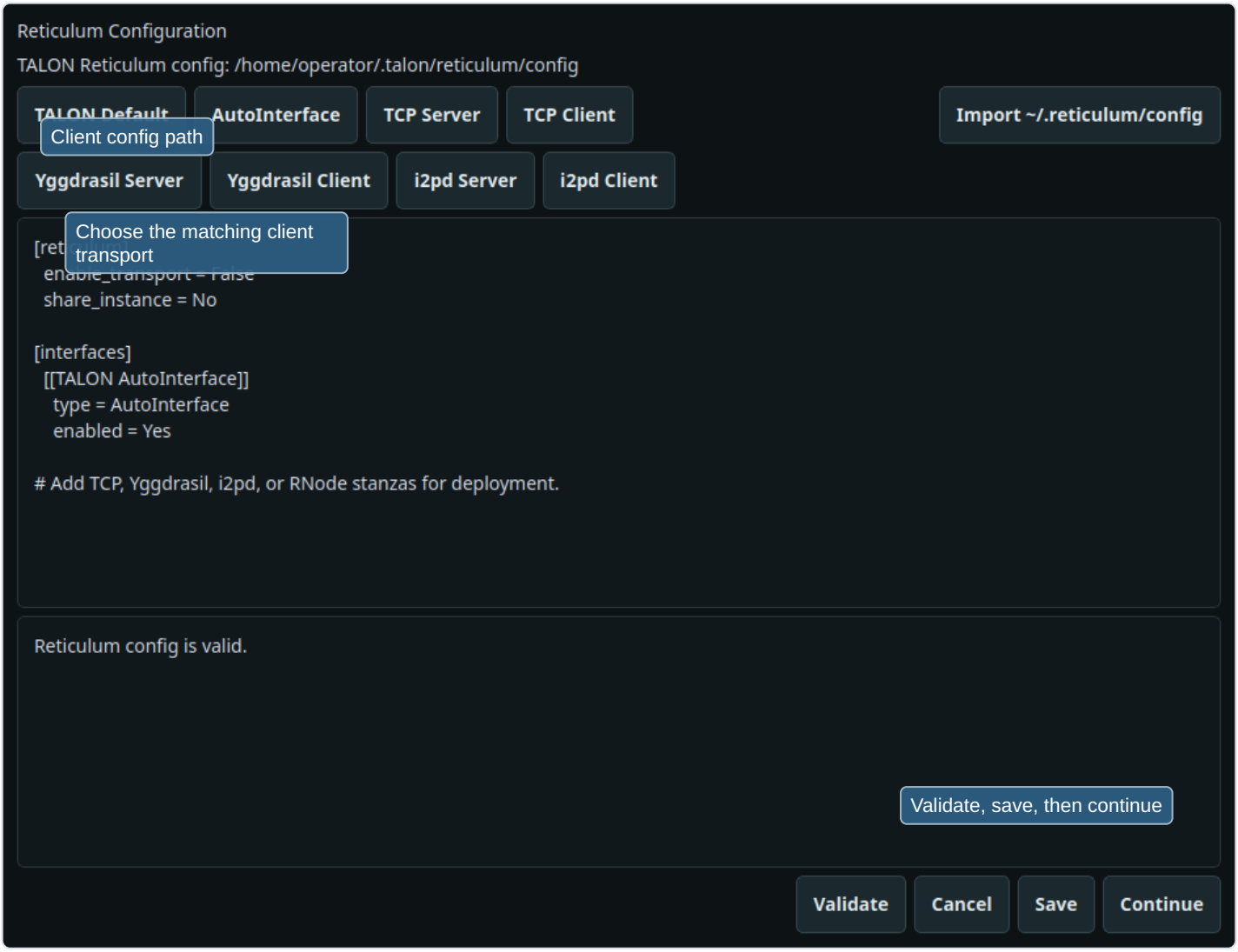
Launch `talon-desktop-client`. Enter the local database passphrase and select **Unlock**. A fresh client remains on the unlock surface until Reticulum setup and enrollment are complete.



Client unlock window.

Configure Reticulum

Network setup is available only after the encrypted database is unlocked. The client uses a TALON-owned Reticulum config under the client data directory. Match the client template to the server deployment path.

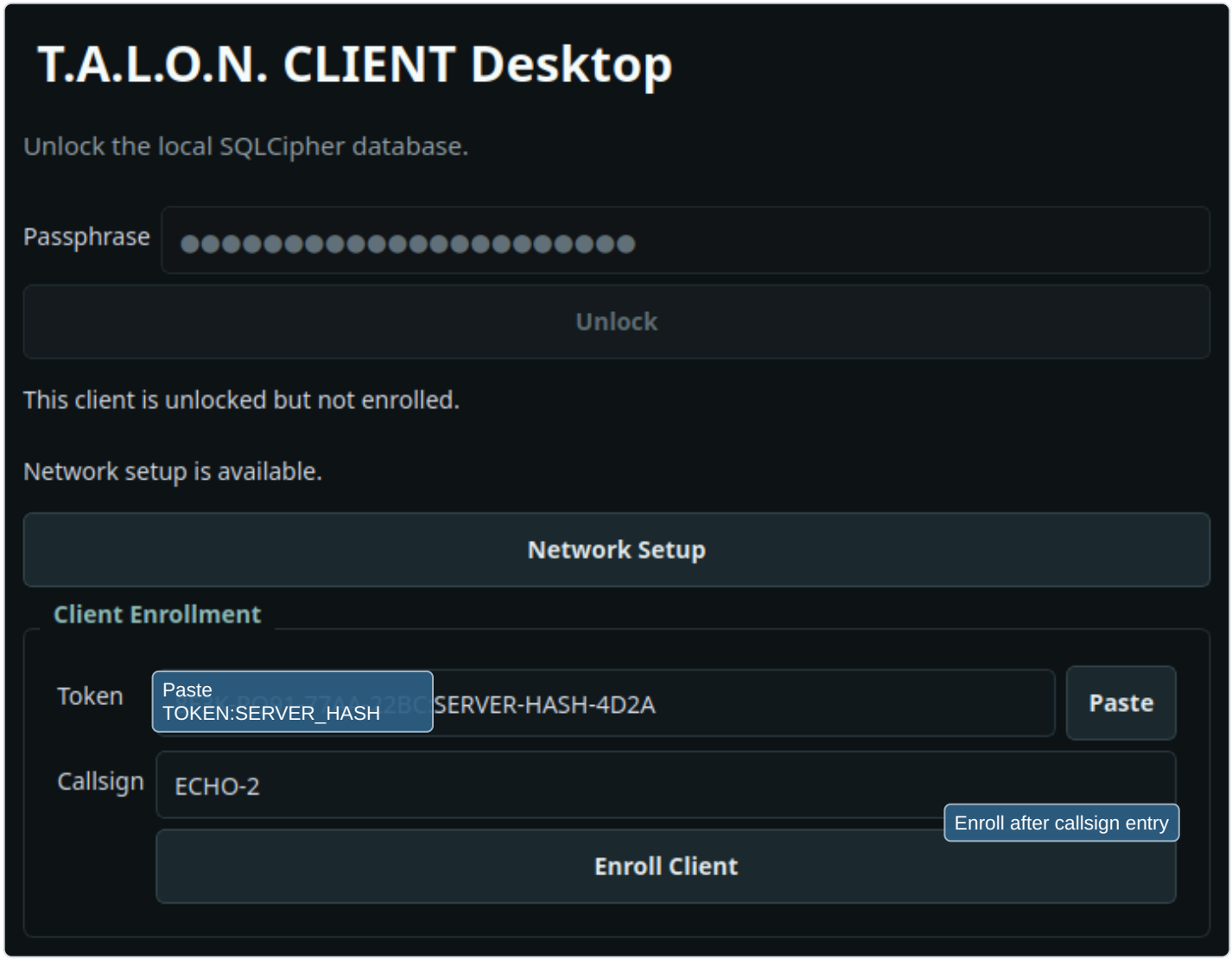


Client Reticulum setup after SQLCipher unlock.

- **AutoInterface** can discover peers on supported local mesh networks.
- **TCP Client** prompts for a server host and port.
- **Yggdrasil Client** prompts for the server Yggdrasil address and port.
- **i2pd Client** prompts for the server peer address.
- If Reticulum is already running, saved changes require restarting TALON before enrollment or sync uses the new config.

Enroll With A Server Token

A server operator must generate a one-time token. Paste the full `TOKEN:SERVER_HASH` value, enter the assigned callsign, and select **Enroll Client**. Enrollment requires the client Reticulum config to reach the server.



Client enrollment prompt after unlock.

Main Shell

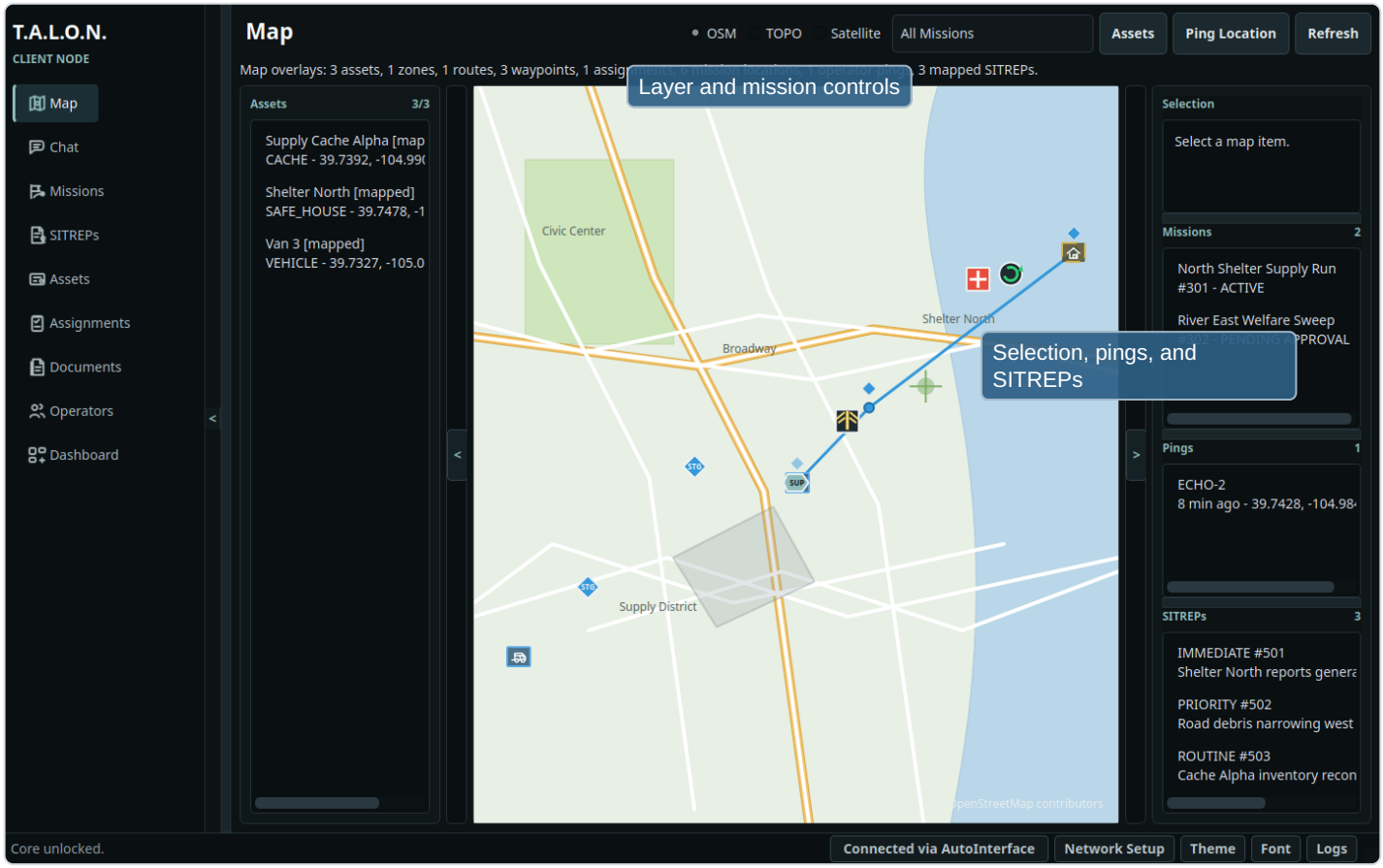
After enrollment, the client main window shows Map, Chat, Missions, SITREPs, Assets, Assignments, Documents, Operators, and Dashboard. Server-only Enrollment, Audit, and Keys pages are not visible in client mode. The status bar shows core unlock state, the redacted network method, Network Setup, Theme, Font, and Logs.

Unread badges: red-dot indicators appear for relevant updates from other operators. Local actions and server echoes of your own actions do not create unread indicators.

Screen Walkthrough

Map

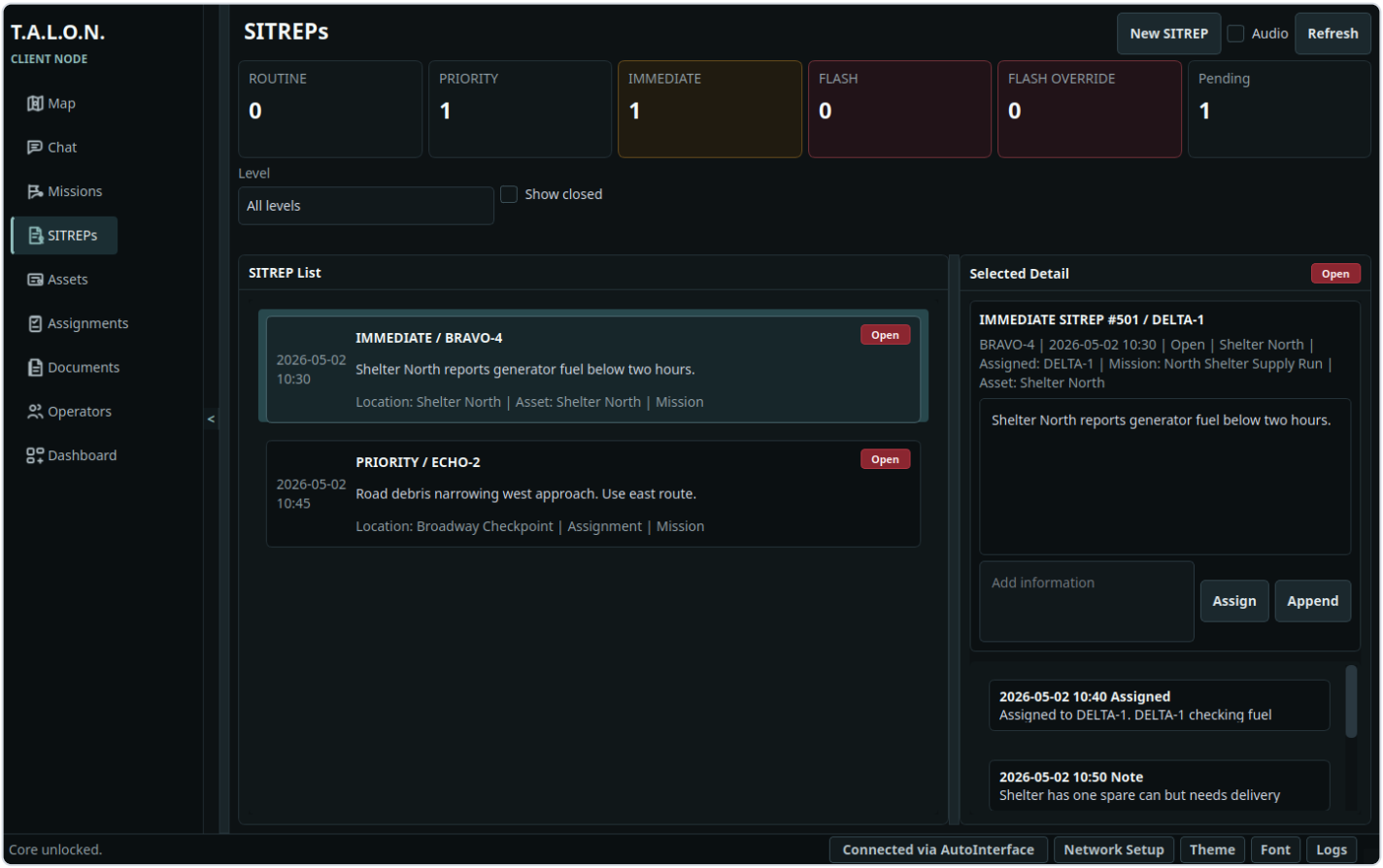
The Map page shows selectable base layers and TALON overlays for assets, mission routes, mission locations, assignments, operator pings, and located SITREPs. Operators can focus a mission, filter visible assets, select overlays, and send a manual Ping Location marker.



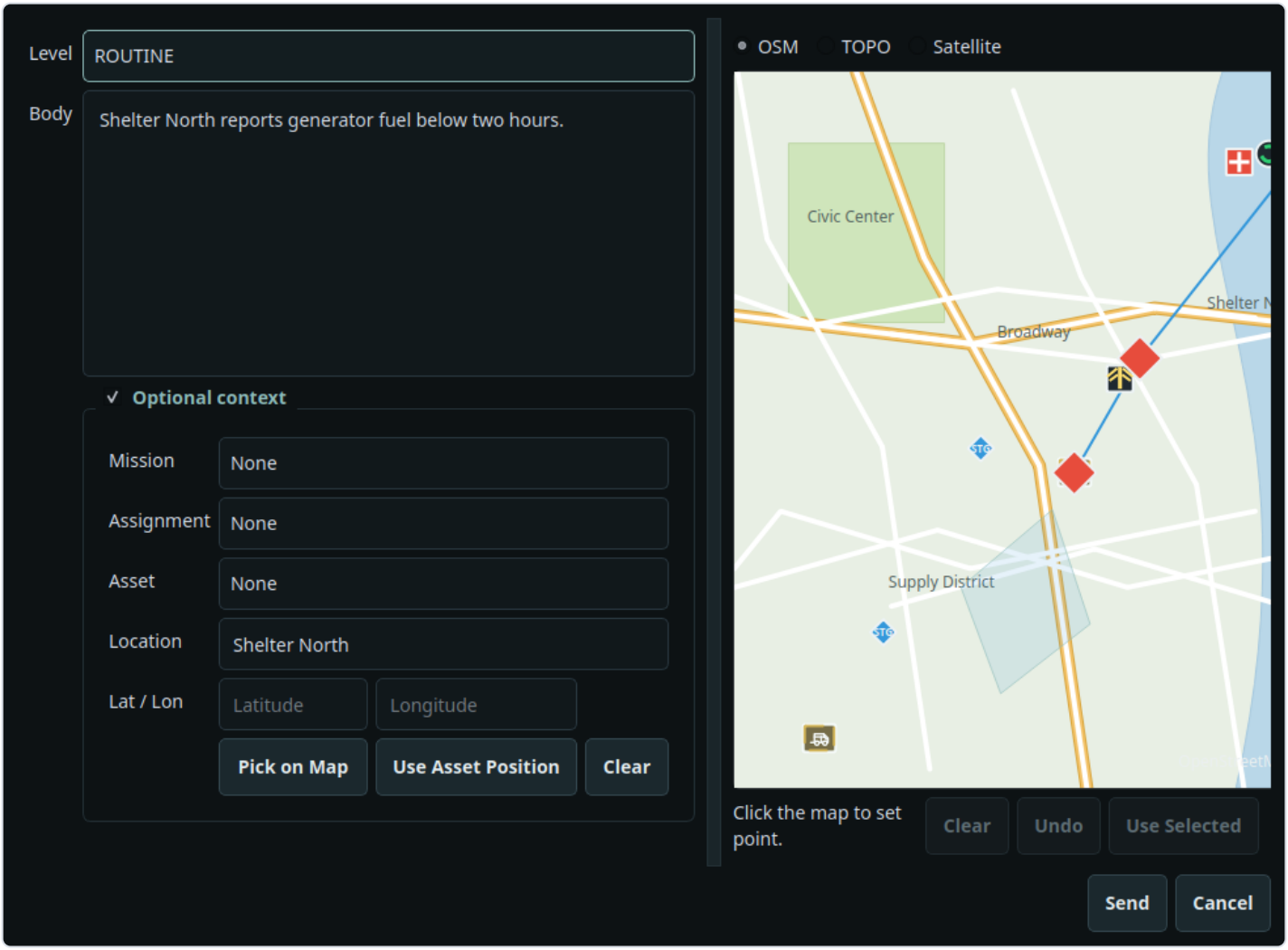
Client map with fallback OSM-style background.

SITREPs

Client operators can create SITREPs, filter by severity, append follow-up information, and assign unresolved reports to available operators. Server-only delete is not shown. FLASH and FLASH_OVERRIDE audio remains opt-in.



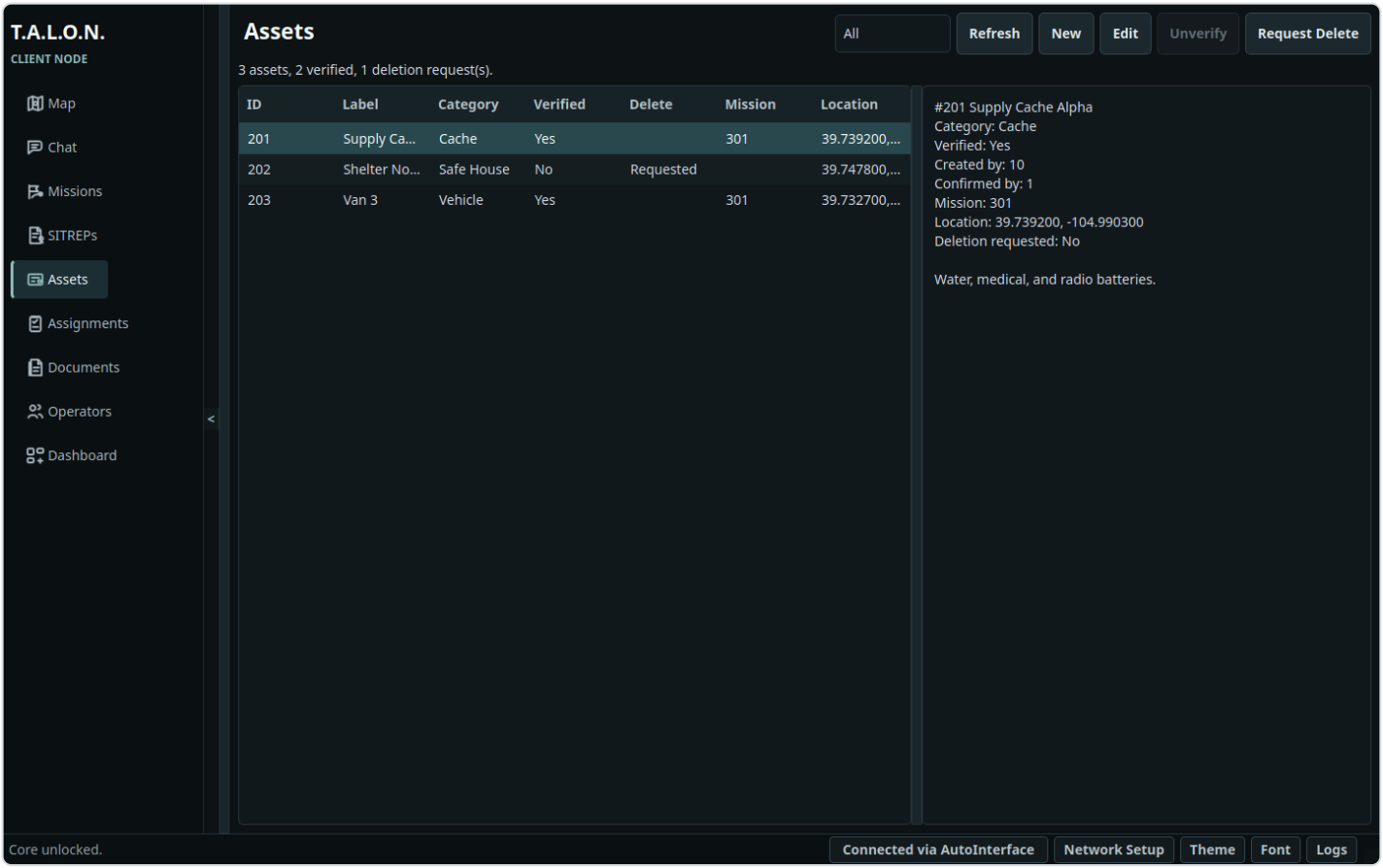
SITREP feed and selected report detail.



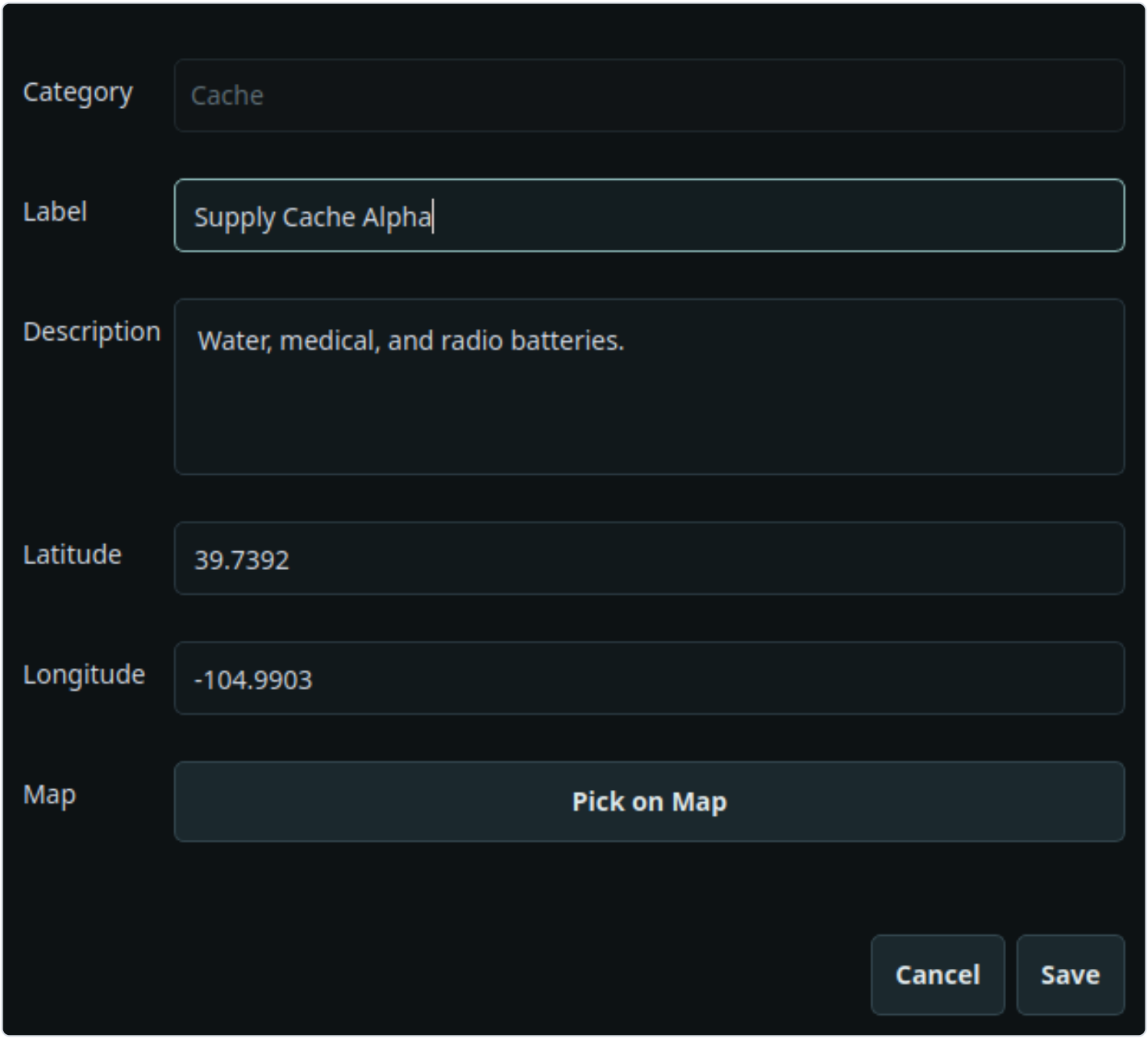
New SITREP dialog with optional mission, assignment, asset, and map context.

Assets

Client operators can create and edit assets, type coordinates, or pick a location on the map. Client deletion uses a request flow; server mode performs final hard delete. Verification depends on authority and asset authorship policy.



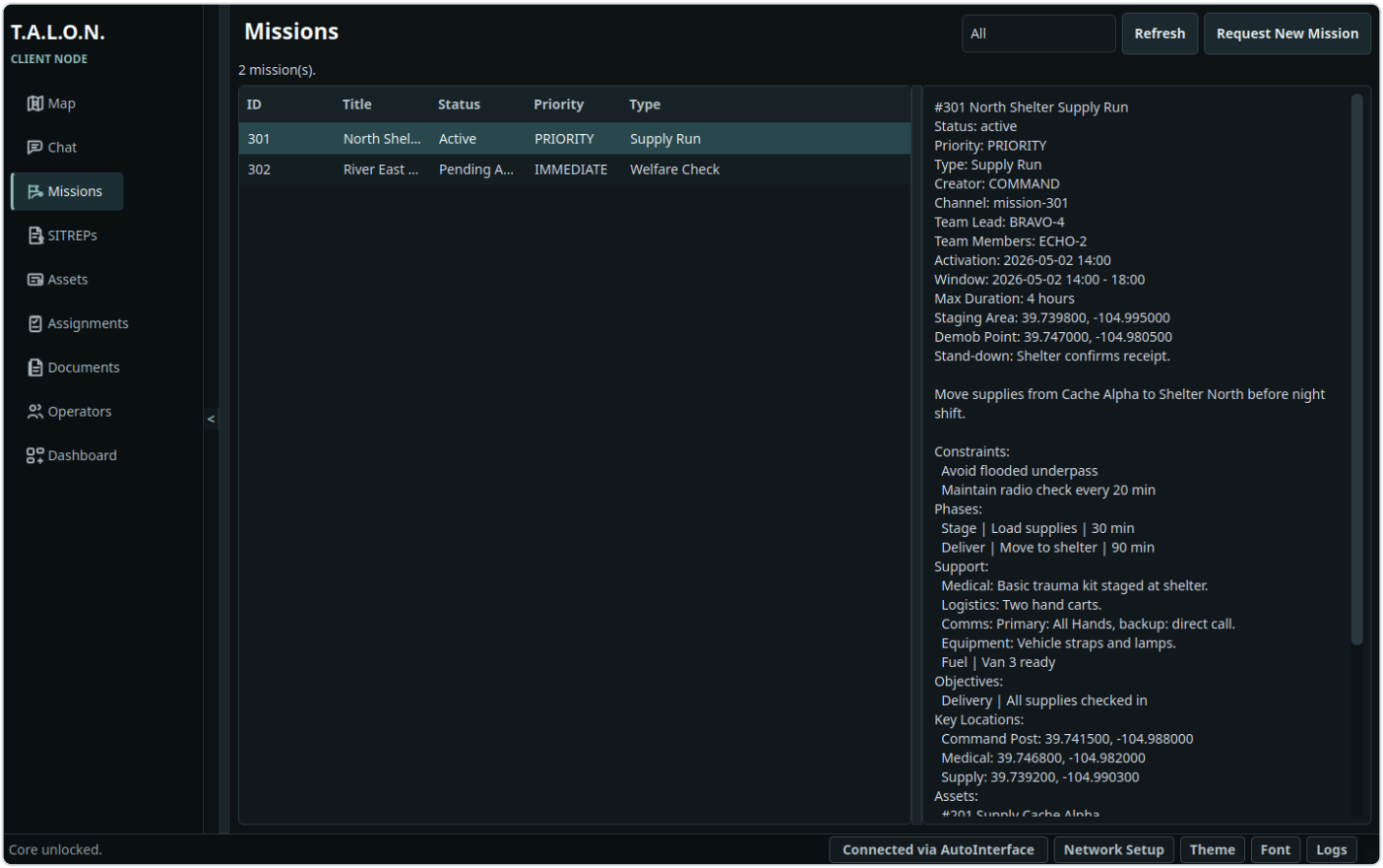
Asset table, category filter, and detail panel.



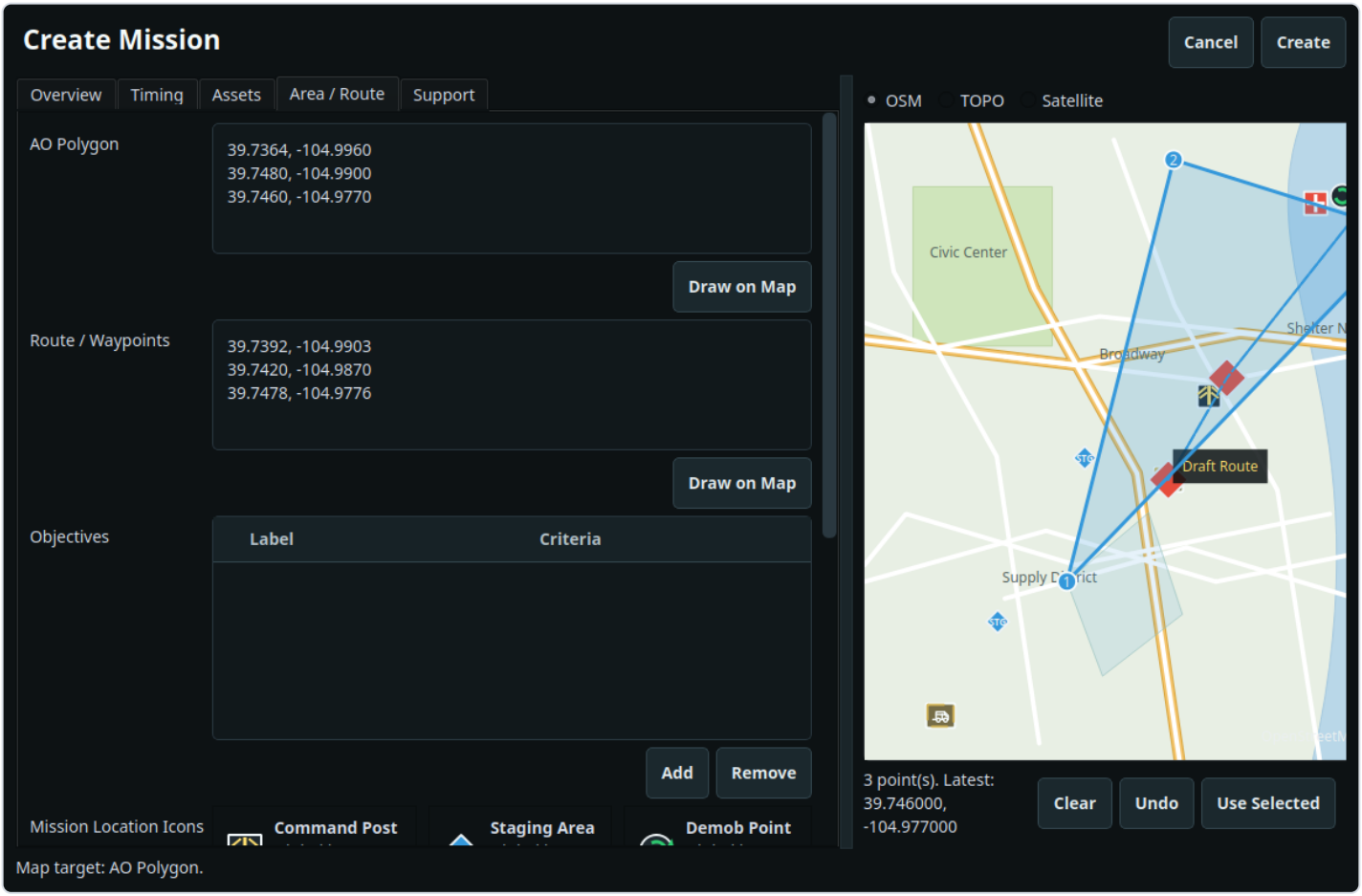
Asset create/edit dialog.

Missions

Client mode labels mission creation as a request. Mission requests can include requested assets, requested team lead, requested team members, AO polygon, route, timing, support notes, objectives, constraints, and key locations. The server approves or rejects requested missions.



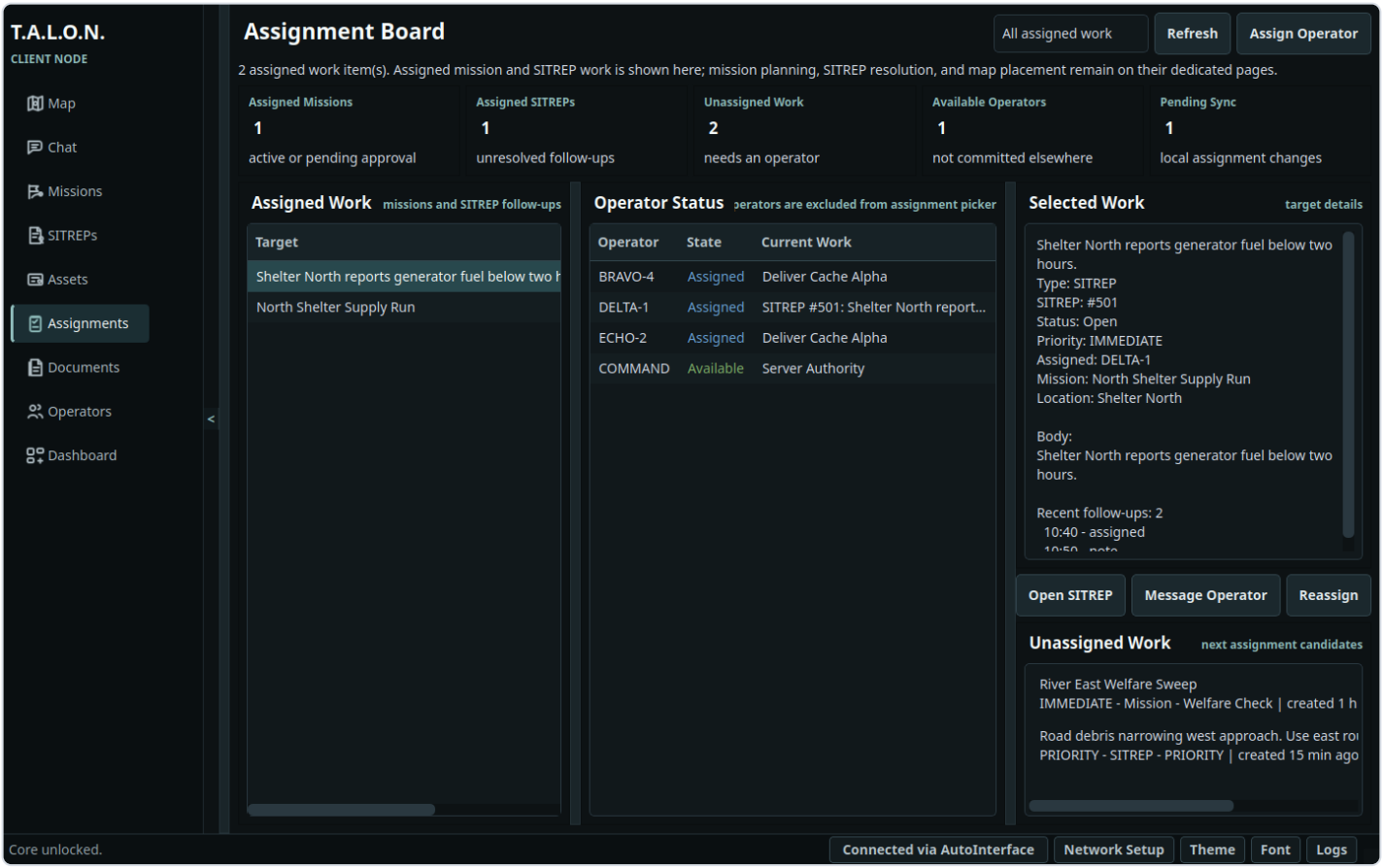
Mission list, status filter, and detail panel.



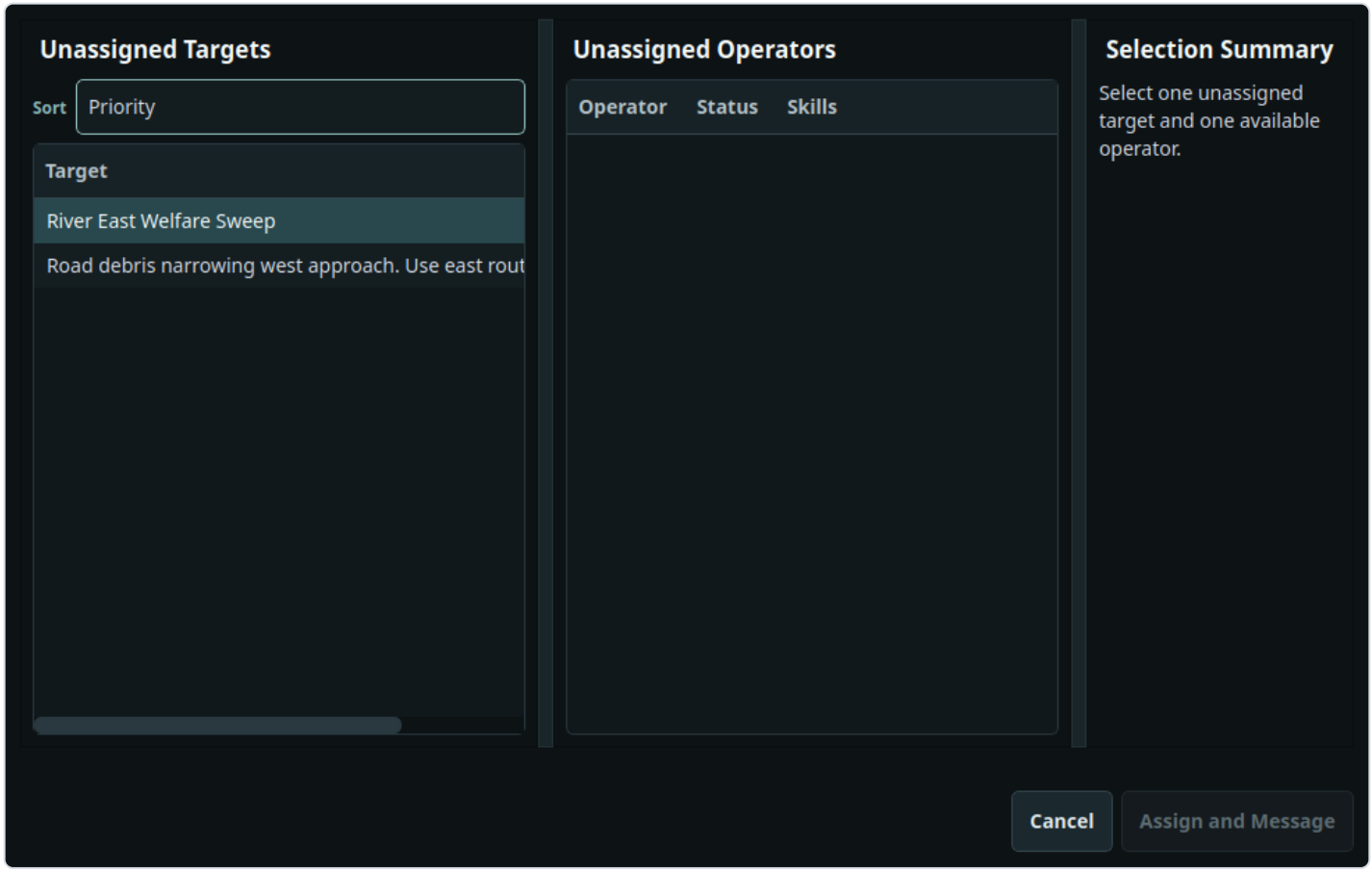
Mission request workflow with embedded map drawing.

Assignments

The Assignment Board shows assigned mission and SITREP follow-up work, operator availability, unassigned work candidates, and pending sync. Client operators can open assigned targets, message assigned operators, and use available assignment workflows allowed by current authority.



Assigned work, operator status, and unassigned work.

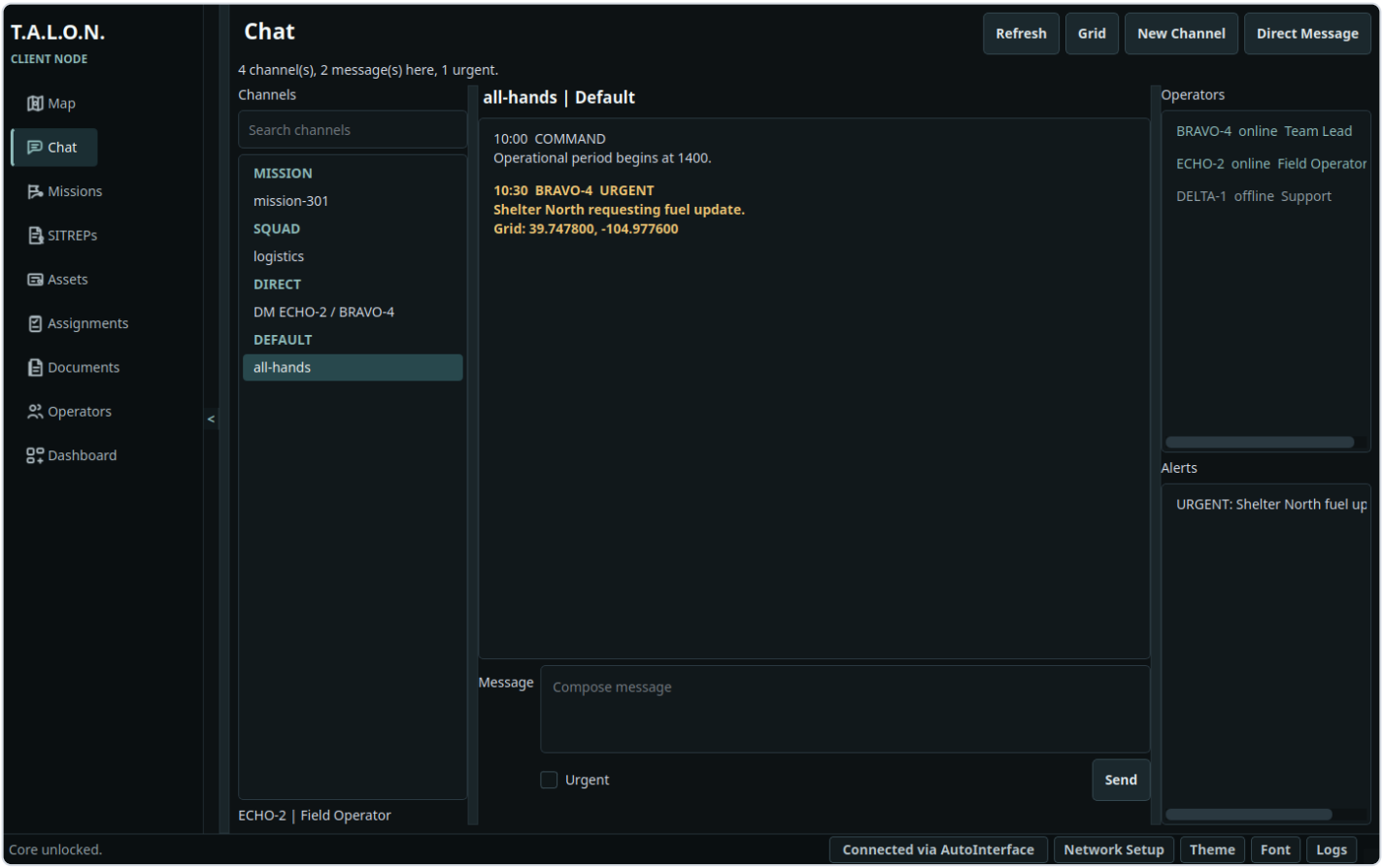


Assign an available operator to unassigned mission or SITREP work.

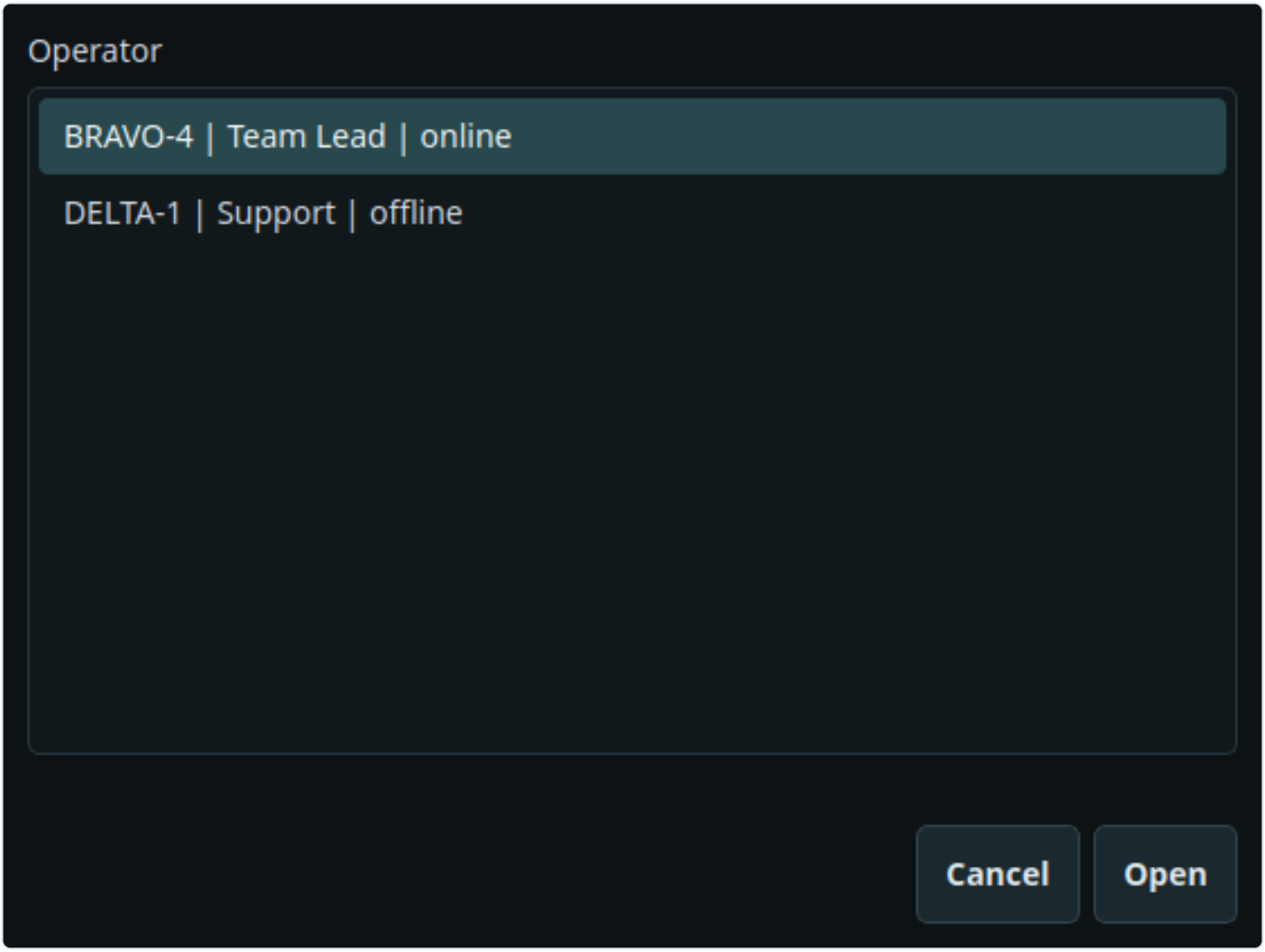
Chat

Chat includes grouped channels, default channels, visible mission channels, custom channels, direct-message channels, urgent messages, grid-reference attachments, operator presence, and alert summaries. Delete controls are server-only.

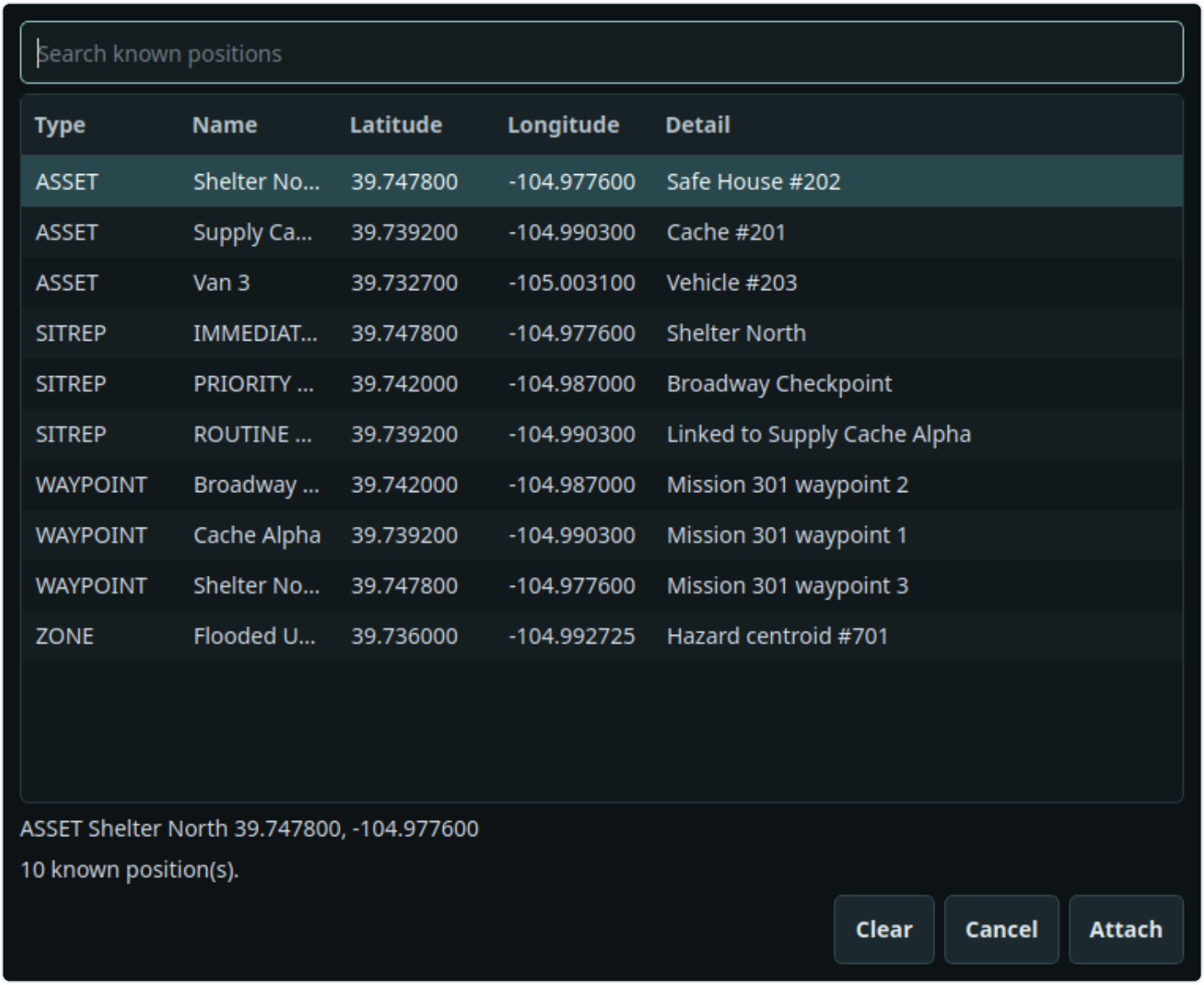
Direct messages: DM channels are server-readable until end-to-end encryption is implemented in core. Treat them as operational messages, not private encrypted messages.



Channel list, message timeline, composer, operators, and alerts.



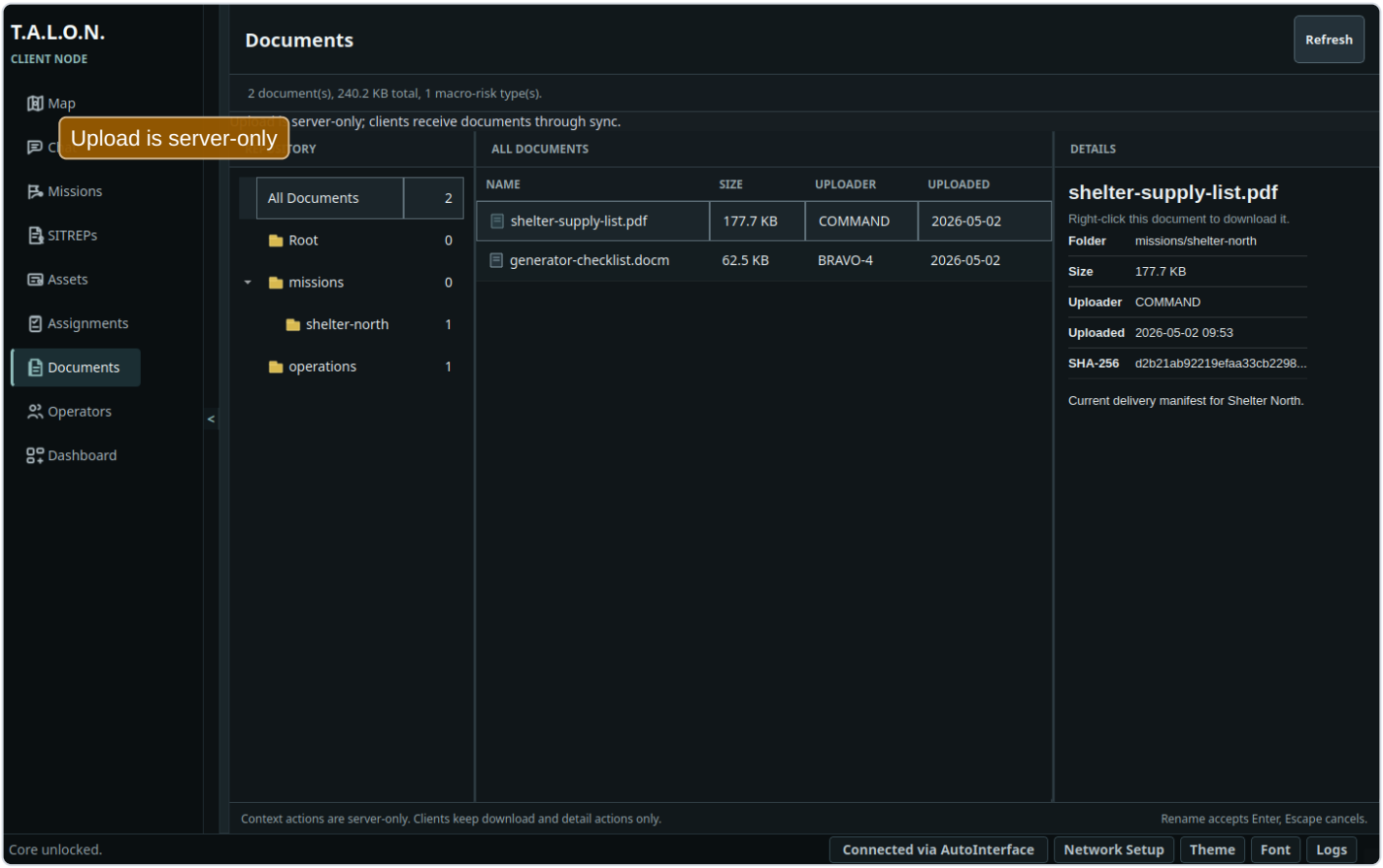
Direct-message peer picker.



Attach a map position to a chat message.

Documents

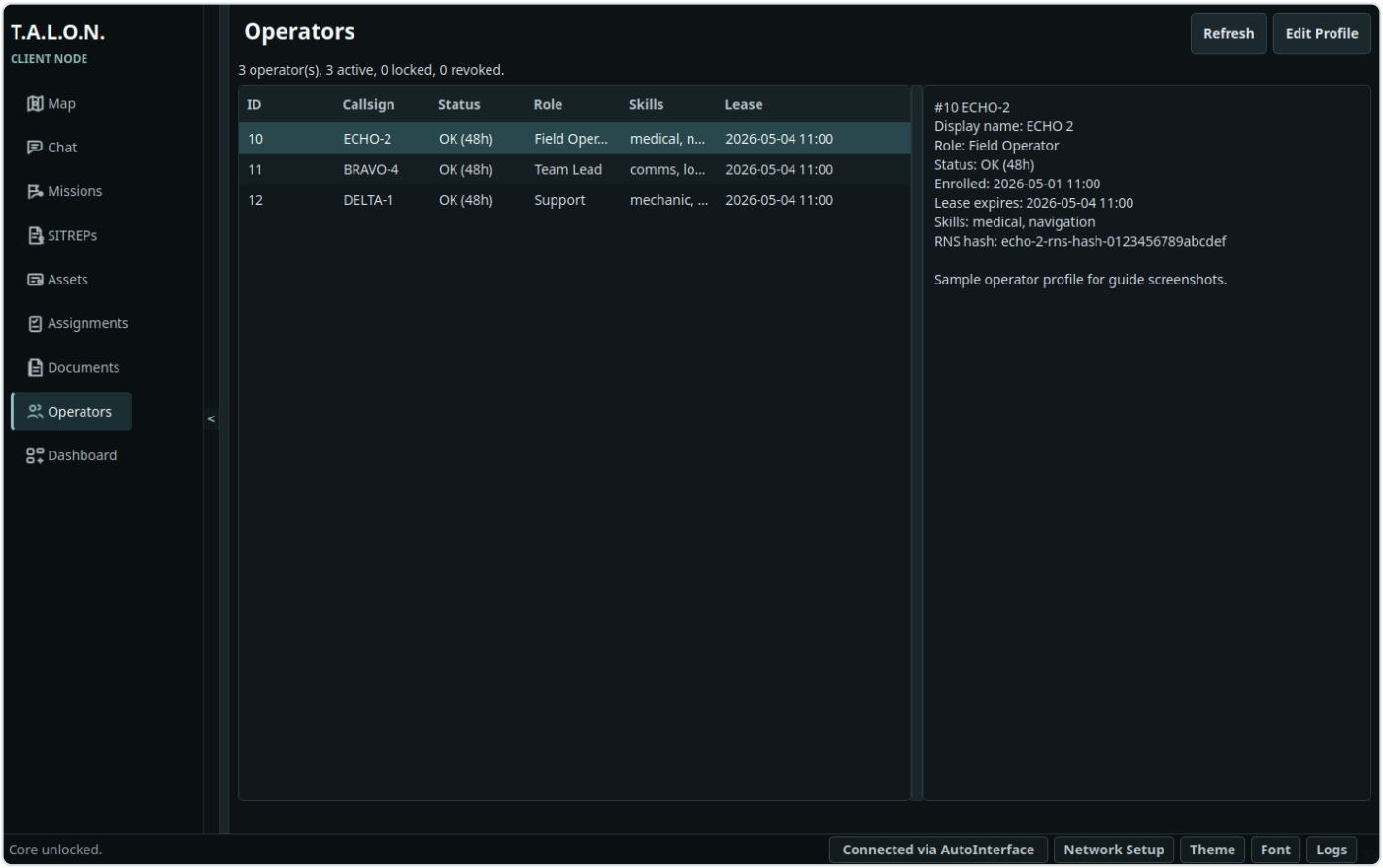
Client mode receives synced document metadata and can download documents through the active sync session. Upload, repository management, and delete are server-only; the client UI displays that restriction directly.



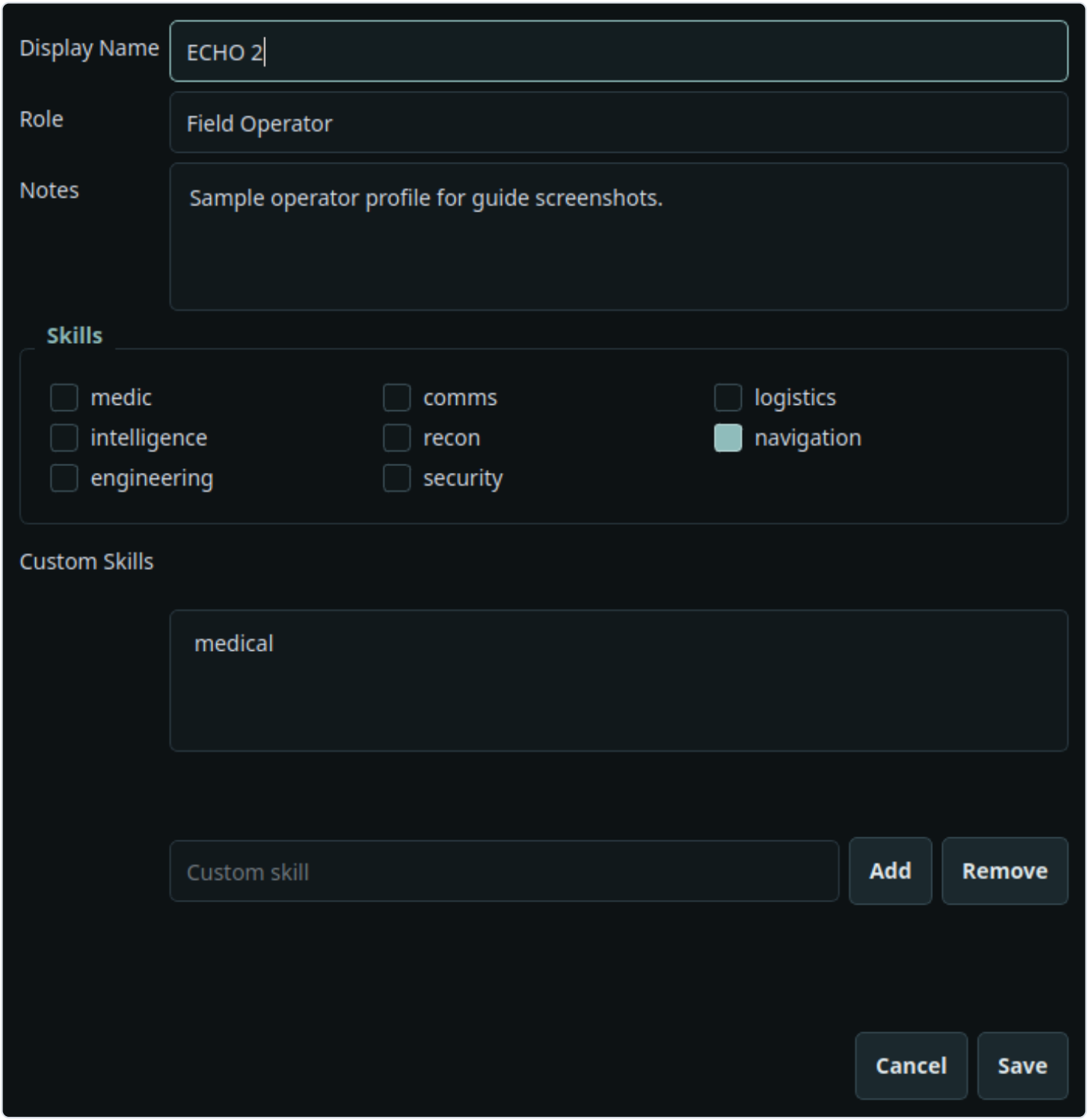
Document repository in client mode.

Operators And Profile

The Operators page shows the enrolled operator roster and lets a client edit its own profile when permitted. Profile editing includes display name, role, notes, predefined skills, and custom skills.



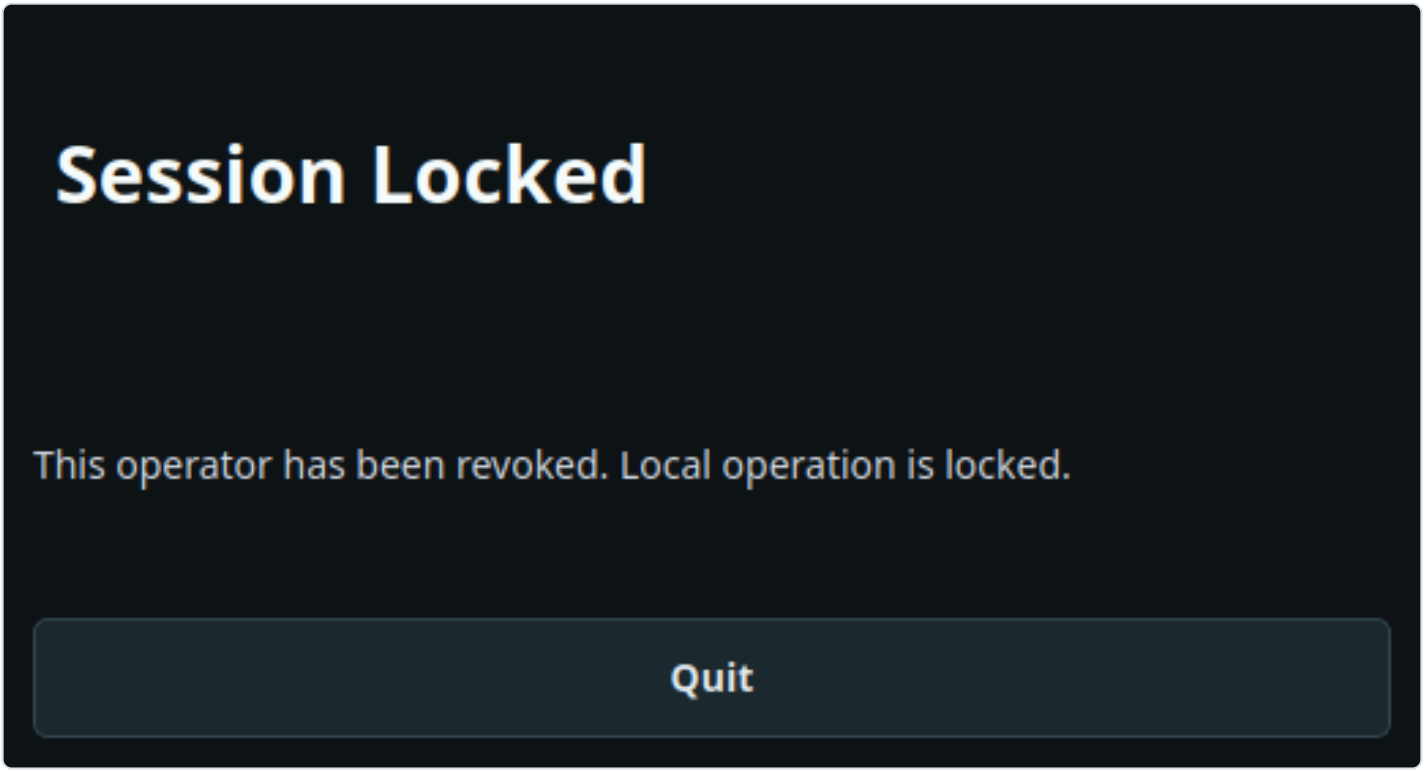
Operator roster and local profile action.



Client profile and skills editor.

Lease And Revocation Lock

If the server revokes an operator or the lease state requires lockout, the client presents a modal lock window. Normal operation remains blocked until the condition is resolved by server authority or the operator quits.



Client lock state after revocation.

Security And Data Handling

Local Database

The client unlocks a local SQLCipher database. The passphrase derives the local key used for database and protected local material.

Network Identity

Reticulum identity material belongs in the TALON client data directory. Do not reuse a server Reticulum directory or another role profile.

Transport

TALON sync traffic uses Reticulum. The desktop reports only the transport family, not addresses, ports, peers, or device names.

Documents

Downloads are verified before save. Macro-capable office formats trigger a risk warning before opening or saving.

Direct TCP: direct TCP can reveal network addressing metadata. Use Yggdrasil, i2pd, LoRa, or a trusted VPN when address privacy matters.

Troubleshooting

Issue	Action
Application will not launch.	Run `talon-desktop-client --smoke --mode client` or reinstall with `--smoke-test`. Check the launcher log path listed above.
Enrollment fails.	Confirm the token is unexpired, the full `TOKEN:SERVER_HASH` value was pasted, the callsign is entered, and Reticulum can reach the server.
Network setup keeps appearing.	Unlock, open Network Setup, validate the TALON Reticulum config, save or continue, then restart if Reticulum was already running.
Document upload is unavailable.	This is expected in client mode. Server mode owns document upload and repository management.
Operator is locked or revoked.	Contact the server operator for lease renewal, revocation review, or re-enrollment guidance.
Direct TCP warning appears.	The active Reticulum method is direct TCP. Change to Yggdrasil, i2pd, LoRa, or a trusted VPN-backed path if address privacy matters.